Amidst dozens of references to walls in the autobiography, Davis included one brief reference to the Berlin Wall, in a scene that takes place at a point of transition in her book. Davis delivers this anecdote in a section of the narrative in which she pivots from student activism abroad toward her eventual return to the United States. Davis writes,

> Each day, I walked across at Checkpoint Charlie—the border point for people with passports from capitalist countries. Crowds of white tourists from the United States would be standing in line, probably waiting to cross the border to tell people they had seen the other side of the "wall"—so they could say, in Kennedy's war-filled words, "*Ich bin ein Berliner*," that is, I'm ready to fight communism. The tourists were always complaining about the wait. But I never had any trouble—each time I went across, I would receive the signal to go on only a few moments after I had shown my passport. This was their way of showing their solidarity with Black people.[12]

Davis locates this scene clearly without ever acknowledging the infamous wall by its most common name. Despite her reflections on Cold War Berlin—including explicit references to Checkpoint Charlie, President John Kennedy's 1963 historic visit to West Berlin, and more in later passages on the time she spent in East Berlin—the words "Berlin Wall" are nowhere to be found in the text. Instead it only appears in scare quotes as "'the wall.'" Davis's distancing of herself from other Western travelers, mostly those from America, near the Wall, reminds readers that her time spent in divided Germany was not merely an excursion away from the United States but a personal flight from Western modes of repression. Her lessons abroad were brought to a head through her time in Cold War Berlin. Later in the autobiography, she highlights Berlin two more times. In the first instance, she mentions SDS protests in 1967 around the state visit of the Shah of Iran to West Berlin in June 1967, and in the second, she describes efforts to protest the screening of *Africa Addio*, an Italian documentary that sensationalized the violence of European colonialism in Africa.[13] Her disavowal of the Wall emerges out of a significant strategy of her autobiography: to represent walls as the architecture of a dominant Western society, as well as spaces of grassroots struggle and solidarity.

From the time Davis left Europe, through her trial and acquittal, and among numerous interviews recalling her time there during graduate school,